Graduate school

For Queens College students in political science or any major thinking about a PhD or a policy master's. Most of the programs in the full guide are free, and many pay you.

Degrees and paths

PhD

Research and teaching. Funded with tuition and a stipend; 5–6 years.

Predoc

A paid research job for 1–2 years before a PhD, open to any major. Apply in the fall of senior year.

MPP

Design and evaluate policy. About 2 years. Baruch's Marxe School is adding one (first class fall 2027).

MPA

Run public and nonprofit organizations. 1–2 years; CUNY programs cost far less than private ones.

MA

Graduate study and methods without a PhD. 1–2 years.

Year by year

Freshman

Explore and protect your GPA

- Take PSCI 100-level courses and PSCI 200.
- Go to one professor's office hours.
- Protect your GPA; many programs cut off at 3.0.
- Summer: a paid job or internship.

Sophomore

Get research experience

- Take an intro statistics course (PSYCH 107 or DATA 205).
- Ask professors about research assistant work.
- Apply for summer research: MIT MSRP, Leadership Alliance, Big Ten SROP, Yale SURF.
- Apply to Honors in the Social Sciences.

Junior

Apply to summer research

Busiest year

- Apply to RBSI, PPIA, MIT MSRP and the Truman Scholarship (November–February).
- Albany session internships (campus dates in October).
- The CUNY Pipeline Program (early March).
- Apply to fall PhD visit programs in July–August.

Senior

Apply, or work first

- Take the GRE by October if your programs want it; ask for letters early.
- The APSA Diversity Fellowship (late October).
- PhD applications close late November to mid-December; apply to policy master's too.
- Or work first: Coro, Urban Fellows, Civil Service Pathways, predocs.

When things usually close

Sept–Oct	Economics predoc jobs, the APSA Diversity Fellowship and QC's fall scholarship application
November	PPIA summer institutes and the Albany session internships
December	Most PhD applications
Jan–Feb	Summer research (RBSI, MIT MSRP, Leadership Alliance, Big Ten SROP, Yale SURF), the Truman Scholarship and Coro
March	The CUNY Pipeline Program and QC's spring scholarship application
July–Aug	Fall PhD visit programs, for rising seniors

Help on campus

Office of Honors and Scholarships
Rebecca Baron, Advisor for Scholarships and Fellowships, helps with statements of purpose, Truman and other fellowships.

Your professors
Office hours, research assistant work and, later, letters of recommendation.

Center for Career Engagement and Internships
Frese Hall 213. Résumé reviews, mock interviews and the stipend for unpaid internships.

Office of Undergraduate Research
The spring research symposium. OUGR@qc.cuny.edu.

Every program and deadline

Exact dates, updated every week, at maljahmi.github.io/qc-polisci-pathways

Student-made guide by Mohamed Aljahmi, not an official Queens College or CUNY publication. Dates change every year; confirm each one on the official page before you apply. Questions: mohamed.aljahmi@qc.cuny.edu.